

25STCV11261 25STCV11261

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 309

Hearing date: 2026-08-28

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Case Number: 25STCV11261 Hearing Date: August 28, 2026 Dept: 309

Superior Court of California

County of Los Angeles

DEPARTMENT 309

TENTATIVE

RULING

PEDRO ORANTES, et al.

vs.

JORGE SERENO, et al.

Case No.: 25STCV11261

Hearing Date: August 28, 2026

Defendants' motions to compel further responses from Plaintiff

Abera Kassa to the Subject Discovery are GRANTED. Plaintiff is sanctioned \$1,400.00.

Defendants' motion to have the Requests for Admission (RFAs) deemed admitted is GRANTED.

Defendants' motion to compel initial responses to Form Interrogatories is MOOT.

On 4/17/2025, Plaintiffs Pedro Orantes and Abera Kassa (collectively, Plaintiffs) filed suit against Defendant Jorge Sereno, alleging: (1) motor vehicle negligence; (2) general negligence. On 9/17/2025, Plaintiff amended the Complaint to add Defendant A.N. TOW, Inc.

On 5/5/2026, Defendants Jorge Sereno and A.N. TOW, Inc. (collectively, Defendants) move to compel further responses from Plaintiff Abera Kassa (Plaintiff) to Requests for Admission, Form Interrogatories, Request for Production and Special Interrogatories (collectively, Subject Discovery)

Discussion

Defendants argue that good cause exists to compel Plaintiff to provide further responses to the Subject Discovery.

On 8/4/2026, pro per Plaintiff provided verified supplemental responses to the Subject Discovery, leading the Court to continue the motions so that Defendants could file replies by 8/20/2026. This necessarily mooted the motion to compel Form Interrogatories (which would now require a motion to compel further).

In reply, Defendants note that Plaintiff's provided supplemental responses did not cure the deficiencies identified. For example, Plaintiff's supplemental responses omitted numerous checked Form Interrogatories entirely, provided incomplete responses where any response was provided at all, and provided another generic Form Interrogatory No. 17.1 response that still fails to identify each Request for Admission by number, the facts supporting each response, the witnesses with contact information, and the documents supporting each specific response. Plaintiff's second supplemental response to Defendant's Form Interrogatories provided only a further response to Form Interrogatory 17.1. Although Plaintiff's new response identified each Request for Admission by number, the response still omitted relevant information directly called for by the interrogatory, and but still left the vast majority of Defendant's requests unanswered.

Moreover, Plaintiff's later attempts to provide partial responses does not change the fact that Defendants incurred

fees and costs because Plaintiff failed to timely comply with discovery on multiple instances.

Plaintiff's pro per status does not exempt him from the requirements of the Code of Civil Procedure. The Court urges Plaintiff to obtain counsel.

Based on the foregoing, Defendants' motions to compel further responses to the Subject Discovery are granted. Plaintiff is sanctioned \$1,400.00 (\$350/hr x 4 hr.) Defendants' motion to have the Requests for Admission (RFAs) deemed admitted is granted. Defendants' motion to compel initial responses to Form Interrogatories is moot.

It is so
ordered.

Dated:
August , 2026

Hon. Jon R. Takasugi

Judge of the
Superior Court

Parties who intend to submit on this tentative must send an email to the court at by 4 p.m. the day prior as directed by the instructions provided on the court website at www.lacourt.org. If a party submits on the tentative, the party's email must include the case number and must identify the party submitting on the tentative. If all parties to a motion submit, the court will adopt this tentative as the final order. If the department does not receive an email indicating the parties are submitting on the tentative and there are no appearances at the hearing, the motion may be placed off calendar. For more information, please contact the court clerk at (213) 633-0517.